SOP-003: Reefer Unit Failure Response

Document ID: SOP-003

Owner: Fleet Maintenance and Dispatch Operations

Applies to: Drivers and dispatchers

1. Purpose

This SOP explains what to do when a refrigeration (reefer) unit stops cooling or fails.

2. Signs of Reefer Failure

- Temperature rising steadily (more than 2°C per hour) while the unit is supposed to be running.
- Reefer alarm on the driver's dashboard.
- Cargo condition score (`cargo_condition_status`) dropping below **0.3**.

3. Immediate Actions (Driver)

1. Pull over safely and check the reefer unit display for error codes.
2. Keep cargo doors **closed** to retain cold air.
3. Try restarting the reefer unit once.
4. Report the error code and current temperature to dispatch.

4. Dispatcher Actions

1. Treat a confirmed reefer failure as a **Tier 1 incident** (see SOP-002).
2. Find the nearest approved cold storage facility or repair depot.
3. If the cargo is fresh perishables or vaccines and repair will take more than **1 hour**, arrange a **transfer to a backup reefer truck**.
4. Record the incident and all temperature readings.

5. Cargo Disposal Rule

- Vaccines that went above 8°C must be **quarantined** and must not be delivered until the QA Manager approves them.
- Fresh perishables above 12°C for more than 2 hours must be **rejected** and not delivered.